THE BECOMING INSTITUTE

OFFICIAL COURSE WORKBOOK

DECISION MASTERY

9 Ways to Make Better Decisions Under Pressure

You are the sum of the decisions you have made and not made.

DECISION MAKING

COURSE WORKBOOK

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INTRODUCTION | Every Decision Shapes Your Destiny

Research by Cornell University found that the average adult makes approximately 35,000 decisions per day. Most are unconscious. But the conscious ones — the ones you deliberate over — are the ones that define your trajectory.

This course and workbook teach you nine proven strategies for making better decisions — faster, clearer, and with greater confidence. By the end, you will have a personal decision-making system that reduces cognitive load, improves outcome quality, and builds decisiveness as a character trait.

Copy of the Ruth Chang TED Talk (featured in this course) explores how hard choices are not burdens — they are opportunities to define who you are. This workbook helps you build that philosophy into daily practice.

> *"It is not the strongest who survive, nor the most intelligent, but the most responsive to change." — Charles Darwin (applied to decisions)*

THE 9 WAYS — DECISION MASTERY FRAMEWORK

1. **Define What You Are Actually Deciding**
   Unclear decisions produce unclear outcomes. Name the exact choice with precision.
2. **Clarify Your Criteria Before Evaluating Options**
   Decide what success looks like before you see the options. Prevents post-hoc rationalisation.
3. **Gather Information Without Drowning In It**
   Set a research deadline. More information after a threshold rarely improves decisions.
4. **Use the Pre-mortem**
   Imagine it is 6 months later and the decision failed catastrophically. What happened? Fix it now.
5. **Apply the 10/10/10 Rule**
   How will you feel about this choice in 10 minutes, 10 months, and 10 years?
6. **Distinguish Reversible from Irreversible Decisions**
   Two-way doors deserve speed. One-way doors deserve depth. Most decisions are two-way.
7. **Remove Emotion From High-Stakes Decisions**
   Sleep on it. Write it out. Use structured frameworks before major choices.
8. **Decide at the Right Energy Level**
   Decision fatigue is real. Make high-stakes decisions in the morning. Preserve cognitive energy.
9. **Build a Decision Journal**
   Record reasoning, expected outcome, and actual outcome. Review quarterly. Improve over time.

DECISION MATRIX WORKSHEET

Decision: _____

CRITERIA	WEIGHT (1-5)	OPTION A	OPTION B	OPTION C
TOTAL SCORE:		___	___	___

PRE-MORTEM WORKSHEET

Decision being made: _____

Imagine it is 6 months later and this decision has failed. What went wrong?

What safeguards will you put in place NOW to prevent those failures?

DECISION JOURNAL — TEMPLATE

Use this template for every major decision. Review your journal quarterly to identify patterns in your decision-making quality.

Date:

Decision being made:

Options I considered:

Criteria I used to decide:

The decision I made and why:

Expected outcome in 6 months:

What could go wrong (pre-mortem):

Actual outcome (review in 6 months):

What I learned from this decision:

COGNITIVE BIASES EVERY DECISION-MAKER MUST KNOW

Anchoring Bias:
You rely too heavily on the first information you receive. Counter: Seek multiple independent data sources before anchoring.

Confirmation Bias:
You favour information that confirms existing beliefs. Counter: Actively seek disconfirming evidence.

Sunk Cost Fallacy:
You continue a bad path because of past investment. Counter: Ask "If I had not invested anything, would I start this now?"

Availability Heuristic:
Recent or vivid events feel more likely. Counter: Use base rates and statistics, not emotional memory.

Overconfidence Bias:
You overestimate your ability to predict outcomes. Counter: Calibrate confidence with historical accuracy data.

Status Quo Bias:
You prefer the current state even when change is better. Counter: Ask "What is the cost of NOT changing?"

Planning Fallacy:
You underestimate how long things take. Counter: Double your initial time estimates as a rule.

DECISION ENERGY MANAGEMENT

Decision fatigue (Baumeister, 1998) is real. Every decision you make depletes the same cognitive resource. This is why judges give harsher sentences before lunch, and why tired leaders make poor choices.

The Energy Management Protocol for Decision Makers:
1. High-stakes decisions: Morning only. Never after 3 PM.
2. Low-stakes decisions: Systemize them (same breakfast, same route, standardised choices).
3. Build decision-free periods: Block time where no decisions are required.
4. Restore cognitive resources: 20-minute walk, meditation, or nap restores decision quality.
5. Delegate low-impact decisions: Reserve yourself for what only you can decide.

What time of day do you make your most important decisions currently?

Which 3 decisions will you systemize to preserve cognitive energy?

THE RUTH CHANG PRINCIPLE — HARD CHOICES AS IDENTITY

Ruth Chang's TED Talk (featured in this course) presents a powerful idea: when a choice is genuinely hard — when neither option is clearly better — it is not because we lack information. It is because both options are equal in different dimensions.

In hard choices, Chang argues, we create our own reasons by choosing who we are. The choice reveals and shapes your character.

This means hard choices are not problems to be solved — they are invitations to define yourself.

The Becoming Institute Application:
When you face a genuinely hard choice, stop trying to find the "right" answer and start asking: "Who do I want to be as a result of this choice?" Then decide from that identity.

What hard choice are you currently facing? Who would you become by choosing each path?

MY 9-DECISION PRINCIPLES

Write your personal 9 decision-making principles below. These become your internal operating system for decisions.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

9.

MY DECISION MASTERY COMMITMENT

The 3 decisions I have been avoiding that I commit to making this month:

My system for making daily low-stakes decisions automatically:

My accountability partner and the date I will share my decision journal with them:

Signature: _____ Date: _____

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Transforming Individuals. Building Leaders. Shaping Generations.

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This workbook accompanies the "9 Ways to Master Decision-Making" course on the Origin platform.

This workbook is your practical companion for transformational learning. Every framework, worksheet, and reflection exercise has been designed to move you from insight to action — from knowing to becoming.

The Becoming Institute believes that education is not a destination — it is a daily practice. Carry this workbook with you. Return to it. Complete the exercises. Discuss them with your accountability partner. Teach them to someone else.

This is not just a guide. This is your blueprint.

Continue your journey at www.origin.com.ng

Official Origin Course Workbook | 9 Ways to Master Decision-Making

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